

Acute Religiosity

By Terri Savage

Dramatic Dialogue – Solomon Tawake & Manamo'ui Lovodua

Summary: Amy visits Dr. Bob to find out why she stills feels “empty” after doing “all the right things”, but her diagnosis is not what she expected.

Characters: Amy, Dr. Bob

Dr. Bob: (Walks in, looks over chart and calls out name) Amy Harris?

Amy: Yes that's me.

Dr. Bob: So you're here for a spiritual check up?

Amy: That's right, doc. Even though I do all the things I'm supposed to do, I still seem... unfulfilled...hollow. I'm here to find out what else I can do.

Dr. Bob: All right, we'll see what we can do about this. I'm Dr. Bob. (extends hand to Amy)

Amy: Dr. Bob? Isn't that a character from the Muppets?

Dr. Bob: Uh...yeah, I think so.

Amy: (Using Muppet voice) So Dr. Bob, where's Miss Piggy?!(Laughs)

Dr. Bob: Cute. Shall we get started?

Amy: Ahem...sure.

Dr. Bob: Let's just go over the spiritual check list. How's your prayer life?

Amy: Great! I pray every day before I eat.

Dr. Bob: Before you eat?

Amy: (Runs through it fast and quick) Yeah, "Thank you Lord for this food, please bless it into my body, Amen." You know. Oh, and I don't do this just for regular meals though; I do this for snacks, too...even breath mints! Yep, I pray daily!

Dr. Bob: I see. And do you attend church regularly?

Amy: Oh yeah, I'm there every Sunday and Wednesday! I even joined the choir....do you want to hear me sing...

Dr. Bob: (interrupting) No that's ok. I believe you. How about reading the Bible. Do you do this regularly?

Amy: Absolutely! I'm committed to reading 4 pages a day and I haven't missed yet!

Dr. Bob: And it's not helping you?

Amy: What do mean not helping me?

Dr. Bob: You know, new revelations, a greater understanding of God's Word, excitement about what you've read? Are you growing as you read and study the Bible?

Amy: Look doc, I don't mean to be disrespectful, but I'm committed to read because that's what I'm supposed to do. I go to church

and pray, just like I'm supposed to do. I came here to find out what else, if anything, I'm supposed to do as a Christian.

As far as I can see, I'm very religious.

Dr. Bob: Yeah, that's usually the first sign of this illness. I think I know what's wrong. You have (takes in a deep breath) 'Acute Religiosity'.

Amy: Acute Religiosity....what's that?!

Dr. Bob: Acute Religiosity is a very common and dangerous condition in which you mistake duties for devotion, responsibility for reverence; works for worship.

Amy: But how? Why? What do I do now? Is there any hope?

Dr. Bob: Start by checking your motives. When you pray, are you truly thankful or are you just talking? When you read, are you trying to learn or just follow through on a commitment? Pay attention to why you do what you do then learn to do them for the right reasons.

Amy: But Dr. Bob how do I know what the right reasons are?

Dr. Bob: Ask God to check your heart. And a good message on the dangers of a disciplined lifestyle wouldn't hurt.

Amy: (Gulps) This is somewhat revolutionary! But... (extends out hand and vigorously shakes Dr. Bob's hand) thank you

Dr. Bob, thank you.